

Check out the display quality

Typically, tablets below ₹ 10,000 come with a display having a resolution of 1024x600 pixels. This is an 'unsaid' benchmark, but with evolving technology you can expect it to be replaced with something better soon. For now, go for a tablet that is at least at par or better than the current trend. Devices like Acer Iconia B1, Asus Memo Pad 7 and Samsung Galaxy Tab 2 311 offer display with this ratio.

Hardware quality

Hardware is the engine on the basis of which your tablet performs. Most 17.7cm tablets today are packed with a single-core and dual-core processor, but it is important to understand the value that different chipset brands bring. You have the likes of Broadcom, Mediatek and many others. So before you make the choice, check out which company's processor is packed in the tablet and what value it brings to the table.

Camera for talk

By this we mean the front-facing camera on the tablet. A front-facing camera is situated on the front of the tablet PC, slightly above the screen. It can be used for video calling (Skype, etc) and taking photos. There are tablets that sport both rear and front cameras, but always keep the latter a priority with the former being an added bonus. In simple terms, look for a better-quality front camera and consider the rear camera as an added bonus.

Calling support

Apart from basic tablets that offer Wi-Fi support, you will also find options that offer 3G data connectivity and voice calling support enabled by an in-built SIM-card slot. Calling support is an additional benefit as you can make and receive phone calls with the tablet.

Long-lasting battery

Tablets are not known for long battery back-up but you can look for one that lasts longer than the rest. Typically, look for a battery in excess of 3000mAh rating. It should last six to seven hours a day. For the rest, you will have to pack the charger everywhere you go.

Build quality

In order to slash the prices, some of the tablet makers are compromising on the build quality of their devices. This is quite common for tablets below ₹ 10,000. So before you buy a tablet, do check its build quality. There is no rocket science involved in the process. A cheap plastic is definitely a no-no. Check the tablet's material, look and feel before you really invest in it.

Operating system

Android is almost a default in tablet PCs priced below ₹ 10,000. We still have to see some OS options venturing in this space. Till then, before you buy a tablet, check out which version of Android it runs. Android 4.2.2, aka, Jelly Bean, is the latest version available in the market, but for budget tablets, Android 4.1 is the latest offering. You will also find Android 4.0, aka, Ice Cream Sandwich version, in some of the tablets, but with the Android cycle moving to the next phase, Android 4.1 will be the standard in use. Samsung, Acer, Lava and Asus have Android 4.1 offerings.

Buy online or in physical stores?

Well, this is really confusing to buyers. We recommend you to do your product research by taking hands-on look at the product and understanding its features, then buy it online (in case you get a deal to die for), where generally you will find cheaper pricing with the additional advantage of varied payment modes like cash-on-delivery, debit card and credit card (with EMI).

SOME 17.7CM MODELS BELOW ₹ 10,000 TO WATCH OUT FOR

Samsung Galaxy Tab 2 311

Samsung Galaxy Tab 2 runs Android 4.1, aka, Jelly Bean. The device is powered by a 1GHz dual-core processor and 1GB RAM, similar to the 3G version of Galaxy Tab 2. It sports a 3MP rear camera and a VGA front-facing camera. Internal storage capacity is 16 GB, which is further expandable via microSD slot. Tab 2 311 comes loaded with a 4000mAh battery.



| Price: ₹ 8999

Acer Iconia B1

Iconia B1 is powered by a 1.2GHz dual-core processor and 512MB RAM. The device comes with an internal storage of 8 GB, which can be expanded up to 32 GB through microSD card slot. Connectivity options include GPS, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi and micro-USB. The tablet has a front-facing 0.3MP camera that can be used for video calling. It comes loaded with a 2710mAh battery.



| Price: ₹ 8999